

MA 104
Lec 8

Review of Power Series

- A power series is an infinite series of the form

$$\sum_{m=0}^{\infty} a_m (x-x_0)^m = a_0 + a_1(x-x_0) + a_2(x-x_0)^2 + \dots$$

Here the consts $a_0, a_1, \dots$ are called the coefficients of the series, & the const. x_0 is called the center of the series.

- A power series $\sum_{m=0}^{\infty} a_m (x-x_0)^m$ is said to converge at a point x if the sequence $\{S_N(x)\}$ of partial sums

$$S_N(x) = \sum_{m=0}^N a_m (x-x_0)^m$$

is convergent, i.e., $\lim_{N \rightarrow \infty} S_N(x)$ exist.

✓ Notice the series certainly converges for $x=x_0$.

- The series $\sum_{m=0}^{\infty} a_m (x-x_0)^m$ is said to converge absolutely at a point x if the series $\sum_{m=0}^{\infty} |a_m (x-x_0)^m| = \sum_{m=0}^{\infty} |a_m| |x-x_0|^m$ converges.

Note. If a series converges absolutely, then the series also converges.

- If a power series $\sum_{n=0}^{\infty} a_n (x-x_0)^n$ converges at $x=x_1$, it converges absolutely for $|x-x_0| < |x_1-x_0|$, & if diverges at $x=x_1$, it diverges for $|x-x_0| > |x_1-x_0|$.

- $\exists$ a positive integer P , called the radius of convergence, s.t. $\sum_{m=0}^{\infty} a_m (x-x_0)^m$ converges for $|x-x_0| < P$ and diverges for $|x-x_0| > P$. The interval $|x-x_0| < P$ is called the interval of converges.

- The root test states that the series converges if

$$c := \limsup_{n \rightarrow \infty} \sqrt[n]{|a_n(x-x_0)^n|} = \limsup_{n \rightarrow \infty} (\sqrt[n]{|a_n|}) |x-x_0| < 1$$

& diverges if $c > 1$. So $\rho = \frac{1}{\limsup_{n \rightarrow \infty} \sqrt[n]{|a_n|}}$.

- The ratio test states that the series converges if

$$L := \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} \frac{|a_{n+1}(x-x_0)^{n+1}|}{|a_n(x-x_0)^n|} < 1$$

& diverges if $L > 1$. So $\rho = \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} \left| \frac{a_n}{a_{n+1}} \right|$.

Rmk. Suppose $\sum_{n=0}^{\infty} a_n(x-x_0)^n$ & $\sum_{n=0}^{\infty} b_n(x-x_0)^n$ converges to $f(x)$ & $g(x)$

for $|x-x_0| < \rho$ for $\rho > 0$. Then the series

$$f(x) \pm g(x) = \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} (a_n \pm b_n)(x-x_0)^n \quad \& \quad f(x)g(x) = \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} c_n(x-x_0)^n,$$

where $c_n = a_0b_n + a_1b_{n-1} + \dots + a_nb_0$ converges at least for $|x-x_0| < \rho$.

- Suppose $\sum_{n=0}^{\infty} a_n(x-x_0)^n$ converge to $f(x)$ for $|x-x_0| < \rho$, $\rho > 0$.
 Then the f is contⁿ & has derivatives of all orders for $|x-x_0| < \rho$. Moreover, $f', f'', \dots$ can be computed by differentiating the series term wise, i.e.,

$$\begin{aligned} f'(x) &= a_1 + 2a_2(x-x_0) + \dots + na_n(x-x_0)^{n-1} + \dots \\ &= \sum_{n=1}^{\infty} na_n(x-x_0)^{n-1} \end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned} f''(x) &= 2a_2 + 6a_3(x-x_0) + \dots + n(n-1)a_n(x-x_0)^{n-2} + \dots \\ &= \sum_{n=2}^{\infty} n(n-1)a_n(x-x_0)^{n-2} \end{aligned}$$

⋮

& each series converges absolutely for $|x-x_0| < \rho$.

- The value of a_n is given by : $a_n = \frac{f^{(n)}(x_0)}{n!}$.

The series $f(x) = \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} a_n (x-x_0)^n = \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} \frac{f^{(n)}(x_0)}{n!} (x-x_0)^n$ is called the Taylor series for the $f^{(n)} f(x)$ about $x = x_0$.

- A fun $h(x)$ is called analytic at a point $x = x_0$ if it can be represented by a power series (Taylor series) in powers of $x - x_0$ with a positive radius of convergence.

Eg. e^x , polynomials, $\cos x$, $\sin x$, f/g (f & g are polyns) are analytic fun except at the zeros of $g(x)$.

- Vanishing of all coefficients: If $\rho > 0$ & $\sum_{n=0}^{\infty} a_n (x-x_0)^n = 0$ $\forall |x-x_0| < \rho$, then $a_n = 0 \forall n \geq 0$.

Shifting of index of summation:

It is immaterial which letter is used for the index of the summation. Sometime it is convenient to make changes of summation indices in calculating series solnⁿ of diff. eqnⁿ.

Eg.
$$\sum_{n=2}^{\infty} a_n x^n = \sum_{m=0}^{\infty} a_{m+2} x^{m+2} = \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} a_{n+2} x^{n+2}$$

Diagram illustrating the shift of index:

- From $\sum_{n=2}^{\infty} a_n x^n$ to $\sum_{m=0}^{\infty} a_{m+2} x^{m+2}$: put $n-2=m \Rightarrow n=m+2$
- From $\sum_{m=0}^{\infty} a_{m+2} x^{m+2}$ to $\sum_{n=0}^{\infty} a_{n+2} x^{n+2}$: put $m=n$

1st term corresponds to $n=2$

1st term corresponds to $n=0$.

But, both contains precisely the same terms.

Eg. 1. Consider the series $\sum_{n=1}^{\infty} (-1)^{n+1} (x-2)^n$. $\rightarrow a_n = (-1)^{n+1}$

Notice $\rho = \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} \frac{|a_n|}{|a_{n+1}|} = \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} \frac{n}{n+1} = \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} \left(\frac{1}{1 + 1/n} \right) = 1$

So the series converges (absolutely) if $|x-2| < 1$ or $1 < x < 3$
& diverges for $|x-2| > 1$.

Eg. 2 Consider the series $\sum_{n=0}^{\infty} \frac{(-1)^n}{k^n} x^{2^n}$. $\rightarrow a_n = \frac{(-1)^{n/2}}{k^{n/2}}$, $x_0 = 0$
 $\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty}$

Notice $\rho = \frac{1}{\limsup_{n \rightarrow \infty} |a_n|^{1/n}} = \limsup_{n \rightarrow \infty} \left(\frac{1}{|k|^{1/2}} \right)^{-1} = \sqrt{|k|}$.

So the series converges if $|x| < \sqrt{|k|}$ & diverges if $|x| > \sqrt{|k|}$.

Convergence Radius $R = \infty, 1, 0$

For all three series let $m \rightarrow \infty$

$$e^x = \sum_{m=0}^{\infty} \frac{x^m}{m!} = 1 + x + \frac{x^2}{2!} + \cdots, \quad \left| \frac{a_{m+1}}{a_m} \right| = \frac{1/(m+1)!}{1/m!} = \frac{1}{m+1} \rightarrow 0, \quad R = \infty$$

$$\frac{1}{1-x} = \sum_{m=0}^{\infty} x^m = 1 + x + x^2 + \cdots, \quad \left| \frac{a_{m+1}}{a_m} \right| = \frac{1}{1} = 1, \quad R = 1$$

$$\sum_{m=0}^{\infty} m!x^m = 1 + x + 2x^2 + \cdots, \quad \left| \frac{a_{m+1}}{a_m} \right| = \frac{(m+1)!}{m!} = m+1 \rightarrow \infty, \quad R = 0.$$

Convergence for all x ($R = \infty$) is the best possible case, convergence in some finite interval the usual, and convergence only at the center ($R = 0$) is useless. 

Q. Find the Taylor series for $f(z) = \frac{e^z}{1-z}$ around $z=0$.

→ Note $f(z) = g(z)h(z)$, where

$$g(z) = e^z = 1 + z + \frac{z^2}{2!} + \frac{z^3}{3!} + \dots \quad \forall z \in \mathbb{R}$$

$$h(z) = \frac{1}{1-z} = 1 + z + z^2 + z^3 + \dots \quad \forall |z| < 1.$$

$$\text{Thus } f(z) = 1 + (1+1)z + (1+1+\frac{1}{2!})z^2 + (1+1+\frac{1}{2!}+\frac{1}{3!})z^3 + \dots$$

$\forall |z| < 1 = \rho$ (Ex.)

eg. The series $\sum_{n=0}^{\infty} \frac{x^n}{n!}$ converges at $x=-1$, but does not converge absolutely. Notice $1 - \frac{1}{2} + \frac{1}{3} - \frac{1}{4} + \dots = \ln 2$, but $1 + \frac{1}{2} + \frac{1}{3} + \dots$ diverges.

Question asked by a student (check!)

Suppose $\sum_{n=0}^{\infty} a_n x^n$ converges to $f(x)$ for $|x| < \rho$.
Then $f'(x) = \sum_{n=1}^{\infty} n a_n x^{n-1}$. If the series $\sum_{n=1}^{\infty} n a_n x^{n-1}$ converges absolutely at some x , can we say $\sum_{n=0}^{\infty} a_n x^n$ converges absolutely?

$$\begin{aligned} \Rightarrow & |a_1||x| + |a_2||x^2| + |a_3||x^3| + \dots \\ &= |x| (|a_1| + |a_2||x| + |a_3||x^2| + \dots) \\ &\leq |x| (|a_1| + 2|a_2||x| + 3|a_3||x^2| + \dots) \end{aligned}$$

converges (given)

(Comparison test)

Since $g(x) = x = 0 + 1 \cdot x + 0 \cdot x^2 + \dots$ also converges absolutely $\forall x \in \mathbb{R}$
 $\Rightarrow$ the series $|a_1||x| + |a_2||x^2| + \dots$ converges to L (say) $\forall |x| < \rho$
 $\Rightarrow |a_0| + |a_1||x| + |a_2||x^2| + \dots$ converges to $|a_0| + L$ $\forall |x| < \rho$
 $\Rightarrow$ The series $\sum a_n x^n$ converges absolutely.

Consider the ODE: $y'' + P(x)y' + q(x)y = r(x)$. - ①

Q. When do a power series soln exist?

Ans. If P, q, r are analytic fns.

Th^m. (Existence of Power Series Solns)

If P, q, r in ① are analytic at $x = x_0$, then every soln of ① is analytic at $x = x_0$ & can thus be represented by a power series in powers of $x - x_0$ with radius of convergence $\rho > 0$.

Ex. Consider the ODE: $y'' + y = 0$ $-\alpha < x < \alpha$. (A)

We look for a soln of the form of a power series $\rightarrow p(x)=0$ & $q(x)=1$
 $y(x) = \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} a_n x^n$ about $x_0=0$ with the radius of convergence $\rho > 0$.
- (1)

Differentiating (1) we get: $y' = \sum_{n=1}^{\infty} n a_n x^{n-1}$ - (2)

$$y'' = \sum_{n=2}^{\infty} n(n-1) a_n x^{n-2} \quad - (3)$$

Substituting (1), (2) & (3) in (A) we get

$$\sum_{n=2}^{\infty} n(n-1) a_n x^{n-2} + \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} a_n x^n = 0$$

recurrence relation $\Rightarrow \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} [(n+2)(n+1) a_{n+2} + a_n] x^n = 0$

$\Rightarrow (n+2)(n+1) a_{n+2} + a_n = 0$

$\forall n = 0, 1, 2, \dots$

By induction, $a_{2k} = \frac{(-1)^k}{(2k)!} a_0$ & $a_{2k+1} = \frac{(-1)^k}{(2k+1)!} a_1$.

Thus

$$\begin{aligned}
 y(x) &= \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} a_n x^n = \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} a_{2k} x^{2k} + \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} a_{2k+1} x^{2k+1} \\
 &= \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} \frac{(-1)^k}{(2k)!} a_0 x^{2k} + \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} \frac{(-1)^k}{(2k+1)!} a_1 x^{2k+1} \\
 &= a_0 \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} \frac{(-1)^k}{(2k)!} x^{2k} + a_1 \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} \frac{(-1)^k}{(2k+1)!} x^{2k+1} \\
 &= a_0 \cos x + a_1 \sin x
 \end{aligned}$$

Ex. Use ratio test to show that each series is convergent $\forall x$.